

Thirty-four more companies join the Linux Foundation

Linux Foundation, the non-profit organisation enabling mass innovation through open source, has announced the addition of 34 new members – 29 silver members and five associate members. Many of the new members have also joined projects such as Automotive Grade Linux, the Ceph Foundation, the Cloud Native Computing Foundation, Hyperledger, LF Edge and Zephyr.

The organisation's members help support the development of shared technology resources, while accelerating their own innovation through open source leadership and participation in some of the world's most successful open source projects including Hyperledger, Kubernetes, Linux, Node.js and ONAP.

Linux Foundation member contributions help provide the infrastructure and resources that enable the world's largest open collaboration communities. The organisation claims that since 2018, on average, a new member joins the Linux Foundation every day.

"We are extremely excited to see 34 more companies make the commitment to open source by joining the Linux Foundation," said Jim Zemlin, executive director, Linux Foundation.

"These organisations, which represent a huge range of industries from around the globe, will contribute valuable resources and knowledge to an already expansive open source ecosystem," Zemlin added.

Linux Foundation's silver members contribute to or otherwise support open source communities and projects. Associate members of the Foundation include government agencies and not-for-profits that have demonstrated a commitment to building, sustaining, and using open source technologies.

The Linux Foundation releases a list of new members joining the organisation every month.

By open sourcing the technology, the company hopes that developers in other nascent and adjacent industries, such as drones, robotics, trucking, fleet management, augmented and virtual reality, and retail, will find applications for this toolkit.

The company believes that an open data and tools strategy can help governments, developers, researchers and the overall industry accelerate towards a smarter transportation ecosystem for the future.

Google plans to acquire Alooka to simplify cloud migration

Google has announced its intention to acquire cloud migration company Alooka, which helps enterprises move their data from multiple sources into one data warehouse.



The acquisition is seen as part of Google's plans to ramp up initiatives to compete with Amazon and Microsoft in the cloud space.

Google did not disclose the price of the acquisition, but it is assumed that the deal was for a modest price,

given the investments Alooka had previously raised. Alooka had raised about US\$ 15 million from investors like Lightspeed Venture Partners and Sequoia Capital, according to TechCrunch.

Google cloud VP of engineering, Amit Ganesh and platform director of product management, Dominic Preuss wrote in a blog, "Here at Google Cloud, we're committed to helping enterprise customers easily and securely migrate their data to our platform. The addition of Alooka, subject to closing conditions, is a natural fit that allows us to offer customers a streamlined, automated migration experience to Google Cloud, and give them access to our full range of database services, from managed open source database offerings to solutions like Cloud Spanner and Cloud Bigtable."

They stressed that the acquisition will also allow customers to take advantage of all the Google technologies, including analytics, security, AI and machine learning.

"One of the things we're most excited about with Alooka is the deep expertise for both enterprise and open source databases that their team brings to Google Cloud, which will be critical in helping us build additional migration capabilities within the Google Cloud platform. We're also looking forward to adding to our growing Google Cloud footprint in Israel, which includes the Velostrata team we added last summer," they added.

EPRI's open source software accelerates implementation of intelligent distributed energy resources

US based Electric Power Research Institute (EPRI) has released an open source communication software based on the Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers (IEEE) 2030.5 standard for intelligent distributed energy resources (DER).

EPRI claims that this free software will help bring DER to the market more quickly and at a lower cost. It will also enable communications between DER and grid operators as per emerging requirements under IEEE 1547 as well as California Electric Rule 21 Interconnection and enhance the value of these systems and devices for consumers, manufacturers and utilities.

"It's critical that solar photovoltaic systems, energy storage systems, and other DER devices communicate with the grid using standard protocols," said Ajit Renjit, principal investigator on this project for EPRI.

"This open source software can enable DER customers, manufacturers and grid operators to maximise the value of interconnected DER and help California and other states reach renewable energy goals," Renjit added.